



system-security baseline also stress “install all the latest service packs” under the same window. Automate now or face non-compliance fines when auditors arrive.

Wi-Fi 7, IPv6 & Lightweight SD-WAN

Wi-Fi 7 (802.11be): When to Jump

Gartner predicts Wi-Fi 7 APs will make up 13% of small-business shipments by the end of 2025, while IDC sees an inflection at 17 % for enterprise-class hardware. Early field tests clock 46 Gb/s PHY and deterministic multi-link lower-latency flows – ideal for AR/VR call centres. Reality check: client devices are sparse and gear costs 2–3× Wi-Fi 6E. Adopt only if (a) you’re cabling fresh Cat 6A anyway, (b) you run 8 K media or VR now, or (c) your next-gen laptops already ship with BCM4398 radios.

IPv6 in India: Already a majority

Akamai’s traffic telemetry shows India delivers ≈62 % of its packets over IPv6, now ahead of the US. Google’s live stats pin global IPv6 usage at 43 % but list India among the “majority” nations crossing 50% overall. Translation: dual-stack every new VLAN; WAN routers without IPv6 support are technical debt.

Upgrade Path: enable [ipv6 unicast-routing](#), request /56 from ISP, DHCPv6-PD to APs, test [curl -6 ifconfig.co](#). Block inbound unsolicited v6 in firewalls – attackers probe it first.

Lightweight SD-WAN for Rs 0 Capex

ZeroTier merges VPN, VLAN overlay, and policy routing in a single SaaS-free binary; admins run virtual lan-IDs and route policy at Layer 3 with <5 MB RAM footprint. Cisco’s Meraki Go GX50 offers browser-click traffic shaping and site-to-site VPN without perpetual licences – handy while it remains on sale – though Cisco has flagged an April 2025 end-of-sale

notice. Fortinet positions Secure SD-WAN Overlay-as-a-Service for “minimal technical expertise,” delivering managed geo-redundant hubs under a pay-as-you-grow model. Edge upgrades in FortiOS 7.4 even add IPv6 segmentation and speed-test APIs per overlay.

DECISION GRID			
Need	ZeroTier	Meraki Go GX	Fortinet Secure SD-WAN
Upfront cost	₹0	₹12 k-₹20 k device	Subscription
Indian PoPs	peer-to-peer	Cloud DC (Mumbai)	Geo-redundant hubs
Max sites	50 virtual	50 VLANs	5 000+
Skill	CLI/JSON	Mobile app	GUI + NOC

If you can script, ZeroTier is unbeatable; if you prefer mobile toggles, Meraki Go is lovely – just mind the product-line sunset. Branches with PCI-DSS or RBI mandates should bank on Fortinet’s ASIC-accelerated NGFWs for SSL inspection.

Key Take-Aways

- **Automate everything** – firmware via Ansible, configs via Oxidized, resets via Autopilot – then document with Git commits.
- **Monitor smarter, not louder** – 95th-percentile and dynamic-mean alerts cut “false red” floods.
- **Table-top drills** expose human gaps long before ransomware does.